

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 25

Group 25 Vocabulary

1. Adept

Meaning: Highly skilled or proficient at something.

Tip to remember: Adept sounds like “adapt.” A skilled person can adapt quickly to tasks.

Sentence: She is adept at solving complex mathematical problems.

2. Adverse

Meaning: Harmful, unfavorable, or negative.

Tip to remember: Adverse sounds like “against.” Adverse conditions work against you.

Sentence: The project continued despite adverse weather conditions.

3. Appropriate

Meaning: Suitable or proper; also, to take something for one’s own use.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: appropriate can mean suitable, but as a verb it can mean take or seize.

Sentence: The government appropriated land for the new road.

4. Archetype

Meaning: A perfect or typical example of something.

Tip to remember: Think of an original model that others copy. That model is an archetype.

Sentence: The wise old teacher is an archetype found in many stories.

5. Articulate

Meaning: Able to express ideas clearly; to express clearly.

Tip to remember: Think of clear articulation in speech. An articulate person explains ideas well.

Sentence: He gave an articulate explanation of his research proposal.

6. Auspicious

Meaning: Favorable, promising, or suggesting future success.

Tip to remember: Think of a good sign before beginning something important. That is auspicious.

Sentence: The project had an auspicious start with strong funding.

7. **Bereft**
Meaning: Deprived of or lacking something; deeply sad because of loss.
Tip to remember: Bereft sounds like “be left.” If you are bereft, you are left without something important.
Sentence: After the failure, he felt bereft of confidence.
8. **Captious**
Meaning: Too critical; tending to find faults in small details.
Tip to remember: Think of someone trying to capture every tiny mistake. That person is captious.
Sentence: The captious reviewer criticized even minor formatting choices.
9. **Conclusive**
Meaning: Final, decisive, and proving something clearly.
Tip to remember: Conclusive comes from conclusion. Conclusive evidence ends the argument.
Sentence: The DNA test provided conclusive evidence.
10. **Conspire**
Meaning: To secretly plan something harmful; to work together toward an effect.
Tip to remember: Think of people whispering together in secret. They conspire.
Sentence: Several officials conspired to hide the truth.
11. **Delineate**
Meaning: To describe, outline, or explain clearly.
Tip to remember: Delineate contains “line.” To delineate is to draw clear lines around an idea.
Sentence: The report delineated the main causes of power loss.
12. **Disentangle**
Meaning: To separate something from a confused or complicated situation.
Tip to remember: Think of untangling wires. Disentangle means to make the messy parts separate and clear.
Sentence: The researcher tried to disentangle the effects of weather and demand.
13. **Exhort**
Meaning: To strongly encourage or urge someone to do something.
Tip to remember: Exhort sounds like “extra heart.” You push someone with extra heart and passion.
Sentence: The teacher exhorted the students to practice every day.
14. **Frailty**
Meaning: Weakness, especially physical or moral weakness.
Tip to remember: Frailty sounds like fragile. Frailty means weakness or fragility.
Sentence: The old man’s frailty made walking difficult.
15. **Grievance**
Meaning: A complaint or feeling of being treated unfairly.

Tip to remember: Grievance comes from grief. A grievance is something that causes emotional complaint.

Sentence: The workers submitted a grievance about low wages.

16. **Harangue**

Meaning: A long, angry, or forceful speech; to lecture angrily.

Tip to remember: Harangue sounds like “her angry.” Imagine someone giving a long angry speech.

Sentence: The coach harangued the team after their poor performance.

17. **Ploy**

Meaning: A clever trick or strategy used to gain an advantage.

Tip to remember: Ploy sounds like “play.” A ploy is a strategic play.

Sentence: The advertisement was a ploy to attract young customers.

18. **Poise**

Meaning: Calm confidence and graceful control.

Tip to remember: Think of a dancer standing perfectly balanced. That balance is poise.

Sentence: She answered the difficult interview questions with poise.

19. **Pomposity**

Meaning: Excessive self-importance or showy dignity.

Tip to remember: Pomposity comes from pomp. Imagine someone acting grand and important for no reason.

Sentence: His pomposity made the simple announcement sound like a royal speech.

20. **Proxy**

Meaning: A person or thing that acts on behalf of another.

Tip to remember: Think of a proxy server acting for your computer. A proxy represents someone else.

Sentence: She voted by proxy because she could not attend the meeting.

21. **Relent**

Meaning: To become less strict, harsh, or firm.

Tip to remember: Think of a strict teacher finally softening and allowing extra time. The teacher relents.

Sentence: After many requests, the professor relented and extended the deadline.

22. **Rhetoric**

Meaning: Persuasive or impressive language, sometimes lacking sincerity or substance.

Tip to remember: Think of political speeches full of powerful words. That is rhetoric.

Sentence: The speech had strong rhetoric but few practical solutions.

23. **Rigor**

Meaning: Strictness, precision, and thoroughness.

Tip to remember: Rigor sounds like rigid. Rigorous work follows strict standards.
Sentence: Scientific research requires intellectual rigor.

24. **Sparse**

Meaning: Thinly scattered, few, or not dense.

Tip to remember: Sparse sounds like “scarce.” Sparse trees mean only a few trees spread out.

Sentence: The village had sparse access to reliable electricity.

25. **Steadfast**

Meaning: Firm, loyal, and unwavering.

Tip to remember: Steadfast means standing steady and fast in one place.

Sentence: She remained steadfast in her goal to study abroad.

26. **Suspect**

Meaning: Doubtful, questionable, or possibly false.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: suspect as an adjective means suspicious or doubtful.

Sentence: The data looked suspect because several values were missing.

27. **Tedious**

Meaning: Boring, tiring, and too long.

Tip to remember: Tedious sounds like “tired of this.” A tedious task makes you tired and bored.

Sentence: Checking every calculation was tedious but necessary.

28. **Vitality**

Meaning: Energy, liveliness, and strength.

Tip to remember: Vital means life. Vitality means life energy.

Sentence: Regular exercise gave him more vitality.

29. **Whimsical**

Meaning: Playfully unusual, fanciful, or unpredictable.

Tip to remember: Whimsical comes from whim, a sudden playful idea.

Sentence: The artist’s whimsical design made the building look magical.

30. **Yield**

Meaning: To produce; to give way or surrender.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: yield can mean produce results, or give in under pressure.

Sentence: The experiment yielded useful results.